CORPORATE POLICY REVIEW REPORT

A Review of the

EMPLOYEE CODE OF CONDUCT

of

ADANI ENTERPRISES LIMITED

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ORGANIZATION REVIEWED: ADANI ENTERPRISES LIMITED

POLICY NAME: EMPLOYEE CODE OF CONDUCT

1. INTRODUCTION

Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) is the flagship company and business incubator of the Adani Group, one of India's largest diversified business conglomerates. Originally established as a trading company, AEL has grown into an incubator of new businesses, having nurtured ventures that later became independent, listed entities such as Adani Ports, Adani Power, Adani Transmission and Adani Green Energy. Today AEL's portfolio spans coal trading and mining, airports, roads, data centres, green hydrogen, agri-business and new energy ecosystems. With operations spread across multiple states and countries, and a workforce drawn from diverse backgrounds, the company depends heavily on a common set of behavioural standards to keep such a wide and fast-growing organisation aligned and accountable.

The policy selected for this review is the "Employee Code of Conduct" of Adani Enterprises Limited, issued as a company-specific extension of the wider Adani Group Policy and Code of Conduct for Employees. This document lays down the values, behavioural expectations, and ethical boundaries that every employee, manager and associate of AEL is expected to follow while carrying out company work, whether dealing with colleagues, customers, suppliers, regulators or the general public.

The purpose of this review is to examine the Employee Code of Conduct as a case study in corporate governance and workplace ethics — to understand what the policy says, why it exists, how well it is designed, and where it could be strengthened. This is not a legal audit but a structured, student-level analysis intended to build practical understanding of how large Indian corporates translate ethical principles into working rules for employees.

2. POLICY OVERVIEW

2.1 Name and Nature of the Policy

The policy is titled "Guidelines for Employee Code of Conduct" and functions as a behavioural and ethics charter rather than a technical operating manual. It is a normative document — it does not tell employees how to do their jobs, but how they must conduct themselves while doing those jobs. It draws directly from the Adani Group's core values and is meant to be read alongside the broader Group Code of Conduct for Employees (Policy

HRP-CCE), with the AEL version adding detail that is specific to AEL's own business context.

2.2 Scope of the Policy

The Code applies uniformly to all employees of AEL, irrespective of whether they are permanent staff, employees on contract, or temporary workers, and it extends to other associates who work with or on behalf of the company. This wide scope reflects a case-analysis principle common in large groups: behavioural standards cannot be optional for some categories of staff and binding for others, because reputational and legal risk arising from misconduct does not distinguish between employment types.

2.3 Employees and Stakeholders Covered

Directly, the Code covers every AEL employee — from entry-level staff to senior leadership — and associates engaged by the company. Indirectly, its provisions protect and concern a much wider stakeholder group: customers, suppliers, contractors, government authorities, shareholders and the communities in which AEL operates, since many clauses (equal opportunity, anti-harassment, anti-bribery) govern how employees treat these external parties.

2.4 Key Objectives of the Policy

- To set out clear, minimum standards of ethical and professional behaviour expected from every employee.
- To ensure that AEL's business is conducted within the legal framework of India and the jurisdictions it operates in.
- To protect the company, its employees and stakeholders from the risks of discrimination, harassment, fraud, corruption and breach of confidentiality.
- To build a culture of trust, integrity and accountability consistent with the Adani Group's core values.
- To provide employees with a channel (whistle-blower / vigil mechanism) to report violations without fear of retaliation.

3. KEY PROVISIONS OF THE POLICY (FOCUS: ETHICS, WORKPLACE BEHAVIOUR, EMPLOYEE RESPONSIBILITIES, DISCIPLINARY MECHANISMS AND GOVERNANCE)

3.1 Workplace Conduct and Equal Opportunity

The Code commits AEL to being an equal-opportunity employer. It prohibits discrimination or unfair treatment of employees, associates or job applicants on grounds such as race, colour, religion, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, age, disability, marital status, citizenship, national origin or any other characteristic protected by law. Employees are expected to treat every colleague with respect and dignity, and managers carry an added responsibility to model and enforce this behaviour within their teams.

3.2 Prevention of Harassment

AEL states a zero-tolerance stance toward discrimination, bullying, harassment or abusive conduct, whether directed at employees, customers, suppliers, contractors or any other party the company deals with. Organisational leaders are made responsible for building a work culture based on dignity, empathy and mutual respect. The policy specifically references compliance with the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) law, meaning that this Code works alongside, rather than replaces, India's statutory POSH framework.

3.3 Confidentiality of Information

Employees are treated as custodians of sensitive company, customer and supplier information — financial, personal or business-related. The Code prohibits any wilful omission or misrepresentation that could compromise the integrity of records, communications or financial statements. Confidential information may be shared only on a strict "need-to-know" basis — with employees or third parties under a confidentiality agreement, with those under a duty to keep it confidential, or where disclosure is legally mandated.

3.4 Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest is defined as any situation where an employee's outside activities or personal relationships clash, or appear to clash, with their duties at AEL. Employees are required to act in the company's interest at all times and must proactively and voluntarily disclose any actual or potential conflict, seeking approval before proceeding, rather than waiting to be found out.

3.5 Fair Dealing, Anti-Corruption and Anti-Money-Laundering

The Code bars employees from anti-competitive conduct such as abuse of market dominance, cartelisation or improper information exchange with competitors. On integrity, it adopts a zero-tolerance approach to bribery, facilitation payments and fraud — employees may neither give nor accept illegal payments, gifts or benefits intended to secure unfair advantage, and any solicitation of a bribe must be refused and reported. The Code additionally binds employees against money-laundering and insider trading, directing that price-sensitive, non-public information must never be used for personal or associates' benefit.

3.6 Whistle-Blower Mechanism and Disciplinary Procedure

Every employee has a positive duty to promptly report any actual or suspected violation of the Code, act of misconduct, or conduct against the company's interest. Reports can be made as a protected disclosure under AEL's whistle-blower policy. Where a breach is established, the matter is handled through the disciplinary procedure laid down under the wider Adani Group Policy on Code of Conduct for Employees, and amendments to the AEL-specific guidelines require the approval of the respective HR Heads of individual AEL businesses.

4. COMPLIANCE AND GOVERNANCE ANALYSIS

The Employee Code of Conduct is not a stand-alone ethical statement; it is built to operate within, and reinforce, a wider legal and regulatory framework applicable to a listed Indian company. Its anti-harassment provisions align with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 (POSH Act). Its equal-opportunity clauses are consistent with constitutional guarantees against discrimination and with labour law principles on fair treatment of workers. Its anti-bribery and anti-corruption stance mirrors obligations under the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, while its insider-trading prohibition directly supports compliance with SEBI's (Prohibition of Insider Trading) Regulations, 2015 — a critical requirement for a listed entity such as AEL. The anti-money-laundering provisions similarly reflect the intent of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002.

From a governance standpoint, the Code is explicitly positioned as a subset of the Adani Group's broader Code of Conduct for Employees, giving it a two-tier structure: group-level principles supplemented by AEL-specific guidance. This mirrors the governance approach

expected of listed companies under SEBI's Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements (LODR) Regulations, which call for documented codes of conduct for directors, senior management and employees, along with disclosure and periodic certification of compliance. The presence of a named escalation point (the Compliance Officer / Company Secretary) for matters such as insider trading, and a formal whistle-blower / vigil mechanism, are both governance mechanisms consistent with the Companies Act, 2013 requirement (applicable to listed companies) to maintain a vigil mechanism for directors and employees.

Taken together, the Code functions as an internal compliance instrument that converts external legal obligations into everyday behavioural rules employees can actually apply, while the escalation and disciplinary route ties individual conduct back to formal governance oversight at the group level.

5. POLICY EVALUATION

5.1 Strengths

- Broad coverage: the Code applies to all categories of employees and associates, leaving no obvious gap in who is bound by it.
- It integrates well with statutory frameworks (POSH, SEBI insider-trading regulations, anti-corruption law), rather than existing in isolation.
- It builds in an accountability channel through the whistle-blower / vigil mechanism, giving employees a route to report misconduct.
- The two-tier design (Group Code plus AEL-specific guidelines) allows consistency across the wider Adani Group while still addressing AEL's specific business context.

5.2 Effectiveness and Practicality of Implementation

On paper, the Code is comprehensive and reasonably easy to read, which supports practical implementation — employees do not need legal training to understand what is expected of them. However, effectiveness ultimately depends on factors outside the text itself: the frequency and quality of employee training, whether whistle-blower complaints are genuinely investigated without bias, and whether senior management is seen to be held to the same

standard as junior staff. Where these supporting mechanisms are weak, even a well-written Code can become a document that exists mainly for compliance filings rather than one that shapes daily behaviour.

5.3 Gaps, Limitations and Areas Requiring Improvement

- The publicly available version of the Code is fairly general in language (for example, on what counts as a "gift" of acceptable value, or the exact monetary/approval thresholds for conflict-of-interest disclosures) and would benefit from clearer, more specific examples.

- It does not specify defined timelines for investigating whistle-blower complaints or resolving disciplinary cases, which can affect employee confidence in the mechanism.

- There is limited public disclosure of outcomes — for instance, how many Code-of-Conduct violations were reported, investigated or acted upon in a given year — which makes external evaluation of real-world effectiveness difficult.

- Provisions on remote and hybrid work conduct, and on employee behaviour on digital/social media platforms, are not explicitly addressed, even though these have become significant sources of workplace conduct issues in recent years.

5.4 Comparison with Good Corporate Practice

When compared with codes of conduct published by other large Indian corporates (such as Tata Group's Tata Code of Conduct or Infosys' Code of Conduct and Ethics), AEL's Code covers broadly similar themes — equal opportunity, anti-harassment, confidentiality, conflict of interest, anti-corruption and whistle-blowing. Where some peer codes go further is in publishing detailed illustrative examples, FAQs, and periodic public transparency reports on the number of ethics complaints received and resolved. AEL's Code would be strengthened by adopting similar illustrative and reporting practices.

6. BUSINESS RELEVANCE

In a business environment where reputation, investor confidence and regulatory standing can be affected within days by a single governance lapse, an Employee Code of Conduct is far

more than a formality — it is a working risk-management tool. For a group as large and diversified as Adani, whose businesses span critical national infrastructure such as ports, airports and energy, the behaviour of individual employees can have consequences that reach well beyond the immediate workplace, affecting public trust, regulatory relationships and shareholder value.

For employees, the Code sets a clear, shared understanding of acceptable conduct, which reduces ambiguity, protects them from being unknowingly drawn into unethical practices, and gives them a legitimate channel to raise concerns. For customers and business partners, it offers assurance that they are dealing with an organisation that has formal standards around fair dealing, confidentiality and anti-corruption. For other stakeholders — including regulators, lenders and the communities AEL operates in — the Code, together with its disclosure and vigil mechanisms, signals a degree of institutional accountability that supports continued trust and cooperation.

Most directly, the Code contributes to AEL's overall risk-management and governance architecture. By embedding anti-corruption, anti-money-laundering and insider-trading provisions into everyday employee conduct rules, it reduces the company's exposure to legal penalties, regulatory action and reputational damage — risks that are especially significant for a listed flagship company operating in sectors subject to heavy public and regulatory scrutiny.

7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Publish more specific, illustrative guidance — for example, defined gift-value thresholds, sample conflict-of-interest scenarios, and step-by-step reporting instructions — so employees can apply the Code without ambiguity.

- Introduce and disclose defined timelines for investigating and resolving whistle-blower complaints and disciplinary cases, to build and demonstrate employee trust in the mechanism.

- Publish periodic (for example, annual) aggregate disclosures on the number of Code-of-Conduct complaints received, investigated and resolved, similar to the

transparency practices of some peer companies, to strengthen external accountability.

- Extend the Code explicitly to cover digital conduct, remote/hybrid work behaviour and appropriate use of social media, given how significantly these affect workplace culture today.

- Mandate periodic, structured refresher training and simple scenario-based assessments for all employees, with special emphasis on new joiners and employees moving into managerial roles.

- Strengthen monitoring by periodically auditing whether senior management and leadership are held to the same disciplinary standard as junior employees, and communicate the outcome internally to reinforce credibility.

8. CONCLUSION

The Employee Code of Conduct of Adani Enterprises Limited is a reasonably comprehensive governance document that translates the Adani Group's stated values into concrete behavioural expectations covering equal opportunity, harassment prevention, confidentiality, conflict of interest, anti-corruption, anti-money-laundering and whistle-blowing. It is well aligned with India's key regulatory frameworks, including POSH, SEBI's insider-trading regulations and anti-corruption law, and it establishes clear escalation routes through the Compliance Officer/Company Secretary and the vigil mechanism.

At the same time, the Code would benefit from greater specificity, published timelines for grievance resolution, more transparent reporting of outcomes, and explicit coverage of digital-age conduct issues. This review highlights a broader lesson relevant to any business student: a Code of Conduct is only as effective as the systems built around it — training, enforcement, transparent reporting and consistent application across all levels of the organisation. A well-drafted Code, if left as a static document, offers limited protection; a Code that is actively communicated, monitored and enforced becomes a genuine driver of ethical culture, regulatory compliance and long-term business trust.

9. REFERENCES

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